



28–35 cm
11–14 in

single blue
chest band

BELTED KINGFISHER
Megasceryle alcyon
F: Alcedinidae

A water kingfisher from N. America, the belted kingfisher is a fishing specialist that often hovers over water before diving for prey.



30–35 cm
12–14 in

**BUFF-BREASTED
PARADISE KINGFISHER**
Tanysiptera sylvia
F: Alcedinidae

Many tree kingfishers, such as this species from New Guinea and N. Australia, nest in holes in tree-top termite mounds.



37 cm
14½ in

**BROWN-WINGED
KINGFISHER**
Pelargopsis amauroptera
F: Alcedinidae

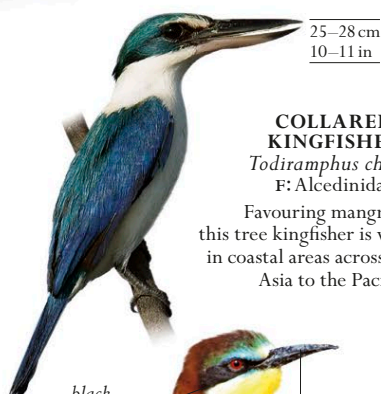
A tree kingfisher of mangrove forests, this species occupies a range from India to the Malay Peninsula.



37–41 cm
14½–16 in

STORK-BILLED KINGFISHER
Pelargopsis capensis
F: Alcedinidae

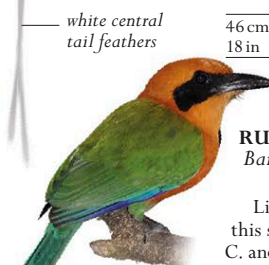
Occurring in southern Asia, this bird is found near water in forests, especially outside the range of the related brown-winged kingfisher.



25–28 cm
10–11 in

**COLLARED
KINGFISHER**
Todiramphus chloris
F: Alcedinidae

Favouring mangroves, this tree kingfisher is widespread in coastal areas across southern Asia to the Pacific.

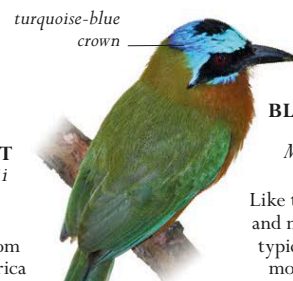


white central
tail feathers

46 cm
18 in

RUFIOUS MOTMOT
Baryphthengus martii
F: Momotidae

Like other motmots, this stout-billed bird from C. and northern S. America sallies for large insects and small vertebrates.



turquoise-blue
crown

41 cm
16 in

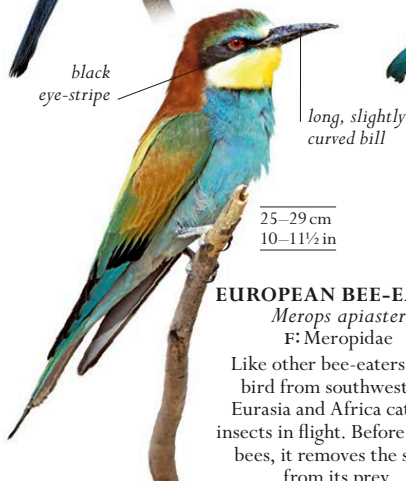
**BLUE-CROWNED
MOTMOT**
Momotus momota
F: Momotidae

Like the related bee-eaters and many kingfishers, this typical brightly coloured motmot from tropical America nests in tunnels in riverbanks.



**TURQUOISE-
BROWED MOTMOT**
Eumomota superciliosa
F: Momotidae

As with other motmots, the racket-tipped tail of this C. American motmot is formed by weakened feather bars that break away.



black
eye-stripe

long, slightly
curved bill

25–29 cm
10–11½ in

EUROPEAN BEE-EATER
Merops apiaster
F: Meropidae

Like other bee-eaters, this bird from southwestern Eurasia and Africa catches insects in flight. Before eating bees, it removes the sting from its prey.



23 cm
9 in

**RAINBOW
BEE-EATER**
Merops ornatus
F: Meropidae

The only bee-eater in Australia, southernmost populations of this species migrate northwards to overwinter in northern Australia and Indonesia.



22–24 cm
8½–9½ in

**WHITE-FRONTED
BEE-EATER**
Merops bullockoides
F: Meropidae

This African bee-eater breeds in large colonies, which have a complex social system with non-breeding birds assisting in raising the young.



22–25 cm
8½–10 in

GREEN BEE-EATER
Merops orientalis
F: Meropidae

Found in dry, open habitats in Africa and S. Asia, the green bee-eater nests in looser colonies than other species of bee-eater.

CUCKOO-ROLLER

Comprising a single rare species from the Madagascar forest, the order Leptosomiformes is placed close to the quetzals of South America, though its affinity to other orders is unclear.

The cuckoo-roller, which survives in fragmented remnant forests, seems less endangered than many other Madagascan species. It feeds like a flycatcher on large insects, but also eats small reptiles. Similar to cuckoos, it is able to digest hairy caterpillars, which most species avoid. Again similar to cuckoos, its two toes face forward and two backwards.

PHYLUM	CHORDATA
CLASS	AVES
ORDER	LEPTOSOMIFORMES
FAMILIES	1
SPECIES	1

CUCKOO-ROLLER
Leptosomus discolor
F: Leptosomatidae

Superficially resembling a cuckoo, this Madagascan predator of small animals is not closely related to true rollers. It nests in tree cavities.

40–50 cm
15½–19½ in

Male has
iridescent
upperparts

Small eye in
bulky head

Short,
thick bill

